

FAMILY

TEXT: Romans 13:1-7 (NKJV) *“Let every soul be subject to the governing authorities. For there is no authority except from God, and the authorities that exist are appointed by God.² Therefore whoever resists the authority resists the ordinance of God, and those who resist will bring judgment on themselves.³ For rulers are not a terror to good works, but to evil. Do you want to be unafraid of the authority? Do what is good, and you will have praise from the same.⁴ For he is God’s minister to you for good. But if you do evil, be afraid; for he does not bear the sword in vain; for he is God’s minister, an avenger to execute wrath on him who practices evil.⁵ Therefore you must be subject, not only because of wrath but also for conscience’ sake.⁶ For because of this you also pay taxes, for they are God’s ministers attending continually to this very thing.⁷ Render*

therefore to all their due: taxes to whom taxes are due, customs to whom customs, fear to whom fear, honor to whom honor.”

INTRO: Today, we begin a six-week series on FAMILY. We are going to use the acrostic FAMILY to talk about what it means to be a part of:

- The human FAMILY...
- The FAMILY of god...
- The Community Transformation Houston FAMILY.

Look at this acrostic:

- F - A place to FLOURISH and thrive...
- A – A place of ACCEPTANCE and unconditional love...
- M – A place to be MOBILIZED...
- I – A place to discover IDENTITY and Kingdom assignment...
- Y – A place to learn to YIELD to authority...

Even though we are doing the acrostic using the word FAMILY, we will not necessarily be going in order as my assignment is Yielding To Authority.

Our Scripture text for today points to the fact that there can be no authority, spiritual or otherwise, without submission on the part of those who are being led by an authority.

For starters, all of us must be under the authority of God, but we also must place ourselves under authority to a human being. This is where it gets a little dicey for us. We willingly submit ourselves to God, but we have issues submitting ourselves to one another.

Submission to authority must be transacted except when such submission would cause us to violate a biblical mandate. (Explain what that is and is not)

Unless submission causes one to violate the Word of God, we are all called upon to submit to all authority, and especially to spiritual

authority. Yet, I must hasten to add, those who misuse authority will most certainly place themselves in the path of the judgement of God. The hand of the Lord is often swift and stern, but sometimes it is slow and sure. One thing is for certain, it grinds to powder.

YEILDING TO HUMAN AUTHORITY

What does it look like to be yielded to human authority? (Yeilding vs. Rebelling – Rebellion is usually an attitude before it is an activity)

First of all, there can never be a healthy human family, a healthy spiritual family, or a healthy local church, without being clear who the leader is going to be, and what the responsibility of the individual members of that family is going to involve.

To have a healthy family of any kind, a leader (Not a dictator & not the children) will have to be identified, and the role of everyone else will have to be established and communicated.

In the human family it looks like this:

- The husband is to be the Spiritual Authority... Sadly there are men who won't step up to this responsibly and their wives must do so. I congratulate you ladies who must fulfill this role – I mourn with the men who refuse to do so – all of us will stand accountable for the leadership we provided in our families – The opinion of everyone in the family must not only be heard but welcomed. At the end of the day, the leader must lead, and everyone else must follow.
- In the Spiritual family, God is in charge... He is the Father of the family. We are His children – He leads – We follow.
- In the local Church family, God is in charge... He has a “*Set*” person in the house, called the Pastor who receives vision from God, and leads the family accordingly. God gives “*Gifts*” of leadership in the church – Elders – Apostles – Prophets –

Evangelists – Pastor’s – Teachers – Helps –
Administration – Etc...

To answer this question, “*What does it look like to be yielded to authority?*” I have chosen to use the words of Jesus. Matthew 10:40 (NASB)

"He who receives you receives Me, and he who receives Me receives Him who sent Me."

Luke 10:16 (NASB) ***"The one who listens to you listens to Me, and the one who rejects you rejects Me; and he who rejects Me rejects the One who sent Me."*** Let us go a little deeper to see what Jesus is saying here:

- If we receive the instructions of a delegated authority (Parent - Pastor), we are receiving the words of Jesus and ultimately of God...
- If we reject the instructions of a delegated authority (Parent - Pastor), we are rejecting the instructions of Jesus and ultimately of God...

In the process of yielding to authority, our attitude in submission is vitally important.

(People will say things to leaders that I have appointed, that they would never say to me! If you disrespect the leaders I have appointed, you have disrespected me – If you disrespect me and/or the leaders God has set in the church, you are disrespecting God. What is true in the church is true at home and at work!

YEILDING TO SPIRITUAL AUTHORITY

When we speak of spiritual authority, we are speaking of those that God has chosen to place over us in the context of His church. Hebrews 13:17 (KJV) ***“Obey them that have the rule over you, and submit yourselves: for they watch for your souls, as they that must give account, that they may do it with joy, and not with grief: for that is unprofitable for you.”***

Look at what is being said here:

- Obey spiritual authority... Believe them – Have confidence in them.
- Spiritual authority is to rule over us... The word “*rule*” here possesses the connotation of a governor or judge – In other words,

spiritual authority is to have the same kind of weight a governor or judge would have over our lives – they have the final say!

- We are to submit ourselves to spiritual authority... The word submit here literally means to surrender to them.
- Our spiritual authorities will give an account for us... Here is what I believe this means - On judgment day, a spiritual authority will not have weight in whether a person is saved or lost, but they will have influence in the eternal reward of those they have been assigned to lead..
- We must live a life of submission to spiritual authority, so that when they our leaders are called upon to give an account for us, they may do it with joy and not with sorrow...
- A spiritual authority giving a good report on our behalf delivers great reward for us...
(“You have been faithful over a few things, I will make you ruler over many things.”)

- A spiritual authority giving a bad report on our behalf will have devastating results... It is after the Judgment Seat of Christ that all tears are wiped away from our eyes.

When choosing a spiritual authority, we must be careful because everything flows down from headship. I want to always make sure that those I place myself under are doing more than I am, because all things flow down in the spiritual realm.

People choose churches for:

- Proximity to their home...
- The preaching style of the pastor...
- The style of music...
- Youth Ministry...
- Children's Ministry...
- Social prestige...

A family should choose a church based on the following things:

- The whole Bible is being preached...

- Jesus is being proclaimed and followed...
- The Holy Spirit is esteemed and highly valued...
- Missions is being promoted both at home and abroad...
- Discipleship is front and center...

CONCLUSION:

I want to end this message by being VERY specific on the how important you are to your local church, and more importantly how valuable you are to Community Transformation Church, Houston.

22 times the New Testament declares we have been “*elected or chosen.*” The Greek word is “*Ek-Lek-Tos*” which means, Chosen by God – Selected – Picked out - The best of its kind – Preeminent. You all are the El-Lek-Tos of Community Transformation Church, Houston. Out of 6,000,000 people in this city, God Ek-Lek- Tos’ed you, to build to be an important

part of His Ekklesia at 9701 Almeda Genoa Road, Houston Texas!!!

What are you going to do about it?

- Continually submit to, or resist authority?
- Be faithful with your finances, or expect everyone else to pay your way?
- Take an all-in attitude, or an indifferent attitude?
- Be faithful, or be undependable?
- Serve, or be served?
- Be an owner, or a renter?